

Employee Data Privacy Policy

Version 1.0 | Owner: People Operations | Effective 2026-01-01 | Next review 2027-01-01

1. Purpose

Zuqah Technologies collects and uses personal data about employees and candidates in order to manage employment relationships, comply with legal obligations and operate the business. This policy explains what data is collected, why, how long it is kept and what rights employees have.

This policy is consistent with India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act) and applicable rules.

2. What personal data we collect

2.1 Data collected from candidates

- Name, contact details (phone, email, address)
- CV/résumé, work history and qualifications
- Identity documents (PAN card, Aadhaar where required for verification)
- References

2.2 Data collected from employees

Identity and contact

- Full name, date of birth, gender
- Photograph (for ID badge and HR systems)
- Home address, personal phone and email

Employment data

- Job title, department, reporting manager
- Employment contract, compensation, benefits elections
- Performance reviews, ratings and feedback
- Attendance, leave records, timesheets
- Training records and certifications

Financial data

- Bank account details (for payroll)
- PAN number (for TDS and Form 16)
- PF (Provident Fund) account number
- Expense claims and receipts

Health data (collected only where required)

- Medical certificates submitted for sick leave
- Information provided for disability adjustments
- Occupational health assessments, where arranged

IT and security data

- Access logs for systems and applications
- Email metadata (sender, recipient, timestamp — not content except in authorised investigations)
- CCTV footage at office premises (see below)

2.3 Sensitive personal data

Health data, biometric data and financial data are treated as sensitive personal data and are subject to additional safeguards including restricted access and encryption.

3. Why we collect and use personal data

Purpose	Legal basis
Managing the employment relationship	Contract; legal obligation
Paying salaries and processing statutory deductions (PF, TDS, PT)	Legal obligation
Processing expense claims and business travel	Contract
Leave and attendance management	Contract; legal obligation
Performance management	Legitimate business interest
Providing references	Legitimate business interest (with employee consent for detailed references)
Compliance with statutory reporting	Legal obligation
Maintaining system security and investigating incidents	Legitimate business interest
Health and safety	Legal obligation; vital interests
POSH compliance and ICC proceedings	Legal obligation

4. Who has access to employee data

Access is limited to:

- People Operations — full access for employment purposes
- Payroll team — financial data for payroll processing
- The employee's direct manager — performance and attendance data
- IT Security — access logs and device data for security purposes
- Finance team — expense claims and reimbursements
- External service providers (payroll processor, benefits administrator) — under

data processing agreements that restrict use to the specified purpose

Employee data is never sold to third parties.

5. Data retention

Category	Retention period
Candidate data (unsuccessful)	6 months from rejection
Employment contract and key HR records	7 years after employment ends
Payroll records and tax documents	8 years after relevant financial year
Performance reviews	3 years
Leave records	5 years
Expense claims and receipts	7 years
CCTV footage	30 days (extended if needed for investigation)
IT access logs	6 months
ICC inquiry records	7 years

After the retention period, data is securely deleted or anonymised.

6. Data security

Zuqah Technologies takes the following measures to protect personal data:

- Encryption at rest and in transit for all systems containing personal data
- Role-based access controls: employees can only see data relevant to their role
- All third-party data processors are assessed for security compliance before

appointment

- Systems containing sensitive data are monitored for unauthorised access
- Employees are trained annually on data handling responsibilities

7. Employee rights under the DPDP Act, 2023

Under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, employees have the following rights:

Right	What it means
Right to access	Receive a summary of personal data held and how it is being used
Right to correction	Have inaccurate data corrected and incomplete data completed
Right to erasure	Request deletion of data where the purpose for processing has ended and no legal obligation requires retention
Right to grievance	Raise a concern with the Data Protection Board of India
Right to nominate	Nominate a person to exercise rights on your behalf in the event of death or incapacity

To exercise any of these rights, contact People Operations at people@zuqahtechologies.com. Requests will be responded to within 30 days.

8. Workplace monitoring

8.1 CCTV

CCTV cameras are installed in public areas of Zuqah Technologies offices (entrances, common areas). They are not installed in private areas (bathrooms, changing rooms, prayer rooms). Footage is reviewed only in connection with a security or safety incident.

8.2 Device and network monitoring

Company-provided devices and the company network may be monitored for security purposes. This monitoring captures metadata (what systems were accessed, when) and is not used to track personal activity. Monitoring is authorised under Zuqah Technologies' IT Acceptable Use Policy.

8.3 Email monitoring

The content of company email is not routinely monitored. Access to email content requires senior management authorisation and will only occur as part of an authorised investigation.

9. Data breach

If a data breach involving employee personal data occurs or is suspected, Zuqah Technologies will:

- Investigate and contain the breach immediately

- Notify affected employees promptly where there is a risk to their rights
- Notify the Data Protection Board of India where required by law
- Take steps to prevent recurrence

Employees who become aware of a potential data breach must report it to the IT Security team immediately at security@zuqahtechnologies.com.

10. Changes to this policy

Zuqah Technologies may update this policy as law or practice changes. Employees will be notified of material changes.

11. Contact

For any questions about data privacy or to exercise your rights:

People Operations: people@zuqahtechnologies.com

Data Protection queries: privacy@zuqahtechnologies.com

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.